

3.5 Building A PHP-Nuke Web Site

PHP, the open source alternative to Microsoft's ASP, is the obvious choice to build a Web site. Why? Because it's cross-platform-a PHP site can be hosted on any Web server, running any OS, unlike ASP, which needs a Microsoft OS-and because it's open source. The biggest advantage of open source software is the thousands of developers who dedicate time to improve or simplify such software. PHP-Nuke is one such product of dedicated developers who decided that people shouldn't need to know how to code in order to develop their own PHP-based Web sites.

There are many offshoots of PHP-Nuke, which is the beauty of open source, and these are listed in the box "Options". The installation and control panel of each does not logically differ much from PHP-Nuke, so you can feel free to experiment with some of them as well. Here, however, we will stick to PHP-Nuke, and learn how to install, configure, and finally, tweak it to give you a Web site that's unique and looks exactly like what you want it to look like.

Pre-requisites

There are some things you will need to have before you can begin setting up your site, such as a domain name and hosting space on a Web server that supports PHP and MySQL databases. Both these are relatively easy to find. On GoDaddy.com, for example, a .COM domain will cost about \$9 (Rs 390) and basic hosting with 25 GB data transfer and 500 MB Web space will cost about \$4 (Rs 175) a month. This brings your total yearly expenditure to about \$57 (Rs 2,500). But remember, this is all you will have to pay. Using this article, you will be able to set up a personal or company Web site for exactly that price and not a paisa more.

Getting PHP-Nuke

Once you've bought your domain name and Web hosting, the next step is to download the PHP-Nuke installer from www.phpnuke.org. The latest version will cost you \$10 (Rs 435) to download, but they offer the previous version for free download. So, as of the